Dr. Li Chen

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Research Interests

Methodologies: optimization under uncertainty; data-driven decision making

Applications: supply chain management; smart city operations; sustainable operations

Academic Appointments

The University of Sydney (USYD) — Sydney, Australia
Lecturer (Assistant Professor), School of Business Analytics & Marketing — 10/2023 – Present

National University of Singapore (NUS) — Singapore
Research Fellow, Institute of Operations Research and Analytics — 08/2022 – 08/2023

Academic Qualifications

National University of Singapore (NUS) — Singapore
Ph.D. in Operations Research and Analytics — 08/2017 – 07/2022

University of Science and Technology of China (USTC) — Hefei, China
B.Sc. in Information and Computing Sciences (Hua Loo-Keng Talent Program) — 09/2013 – 06/2017

Working Papers

Chen, **Li**, Tao Feng, Qinghe Sun, and Lingxiao Wu. *Adaptive emergency operations: A three-stage robust optimization model*, 2026.

Chen, **Li**, Xun Zhang, and Minglong Zhou. *Robust logit-based analytics*, 2026.

Li, Mingyang, **Li Chen**, and Qinghe Sun. *A branch-and-price algorithm for feeder network design with continuous sailing speed optimization*, 2026.

Zhao, Ziao, **Li Chen**, and Qinghe Sun. *Analytics for on-demand food delivery: A Hurwicz satisficing perspective*, 2026.

Publications

Chen, **Li**, Mabel C Chou, and Qinghe Sun. "Process flexibility: A distribution-free approach to long chain resilience". *Operations Research* 74, no. 1 (2026): 1–24. DOI: 10.1287/opre.2023.0430.

Chen, **Li**, Arjun Ramachandra, and Napat Rujeerapaiboon. "Robust data-driven CARA optimization". *Mathematical Programming* (2026). DOI: 10.1007/s10107-026-02429-y.

Chen, **Li**, Melvyn Sim, Xun Zhang, Long Zhao, and Minglong Zhou. "Robust actionable prescriptive analytics". *Operations Research* 74, no. 1 (2026): 550–571. DOI: 10.1287/opre.2023.0300.

Fu, Chenyi, **Li Chen**, and Zhiyuan Lou. "Rank-constrained mixed-integer optimization for heterogeneous sensor location in route reconstruction". *INFORMS Journal on Computing* (2026). DOI: 10.1287/ijoc.2024.0965.

Sun, Qinghe, **Li Chen**, Mabel C. Chou, and Qiang Meng. "Risk mitigation in green technology investment". In *Encyclopedia in Operations Management*, First Edition, 167–174. Oxford: Elsevier, 2026. ISBN: 978-0-443-28994-1. DOI: 10.1016/B978-0-443-28993-4.00070-6.

Zhang, Xun, Qinshen Tang, Zhi Chen, and **Li Chen**. "Managing inventory and pricing with contextual robust optimization". *Management Science* (2026). DOI: https://doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.2024.06402.

Chen, **Li**, Chenyi Fu, Fan Si, Melvyn Sim, and Peng Xiong. "Robust optimization with moment-dispersion ambiguity". *Operations Research* 73, no. 6 (2025): 3118–3138. DOI: 10.1287/opre.2023.0579.

Chen, **Li**, and Melvyn Sim. "Robust CARA optimization". *Operations Research* 73, no. 3 (2025): 1459–1478. DOI: 10.1287/opre.2021.0654.

Chen, **Li**, Long He, and Yangfang Zhou. "An exponential cone programming approach for managing electric vehicle charging". *Operations Research* 72, no. 5 (2024): 2215–2240. DOI: 10.1287/opre.2023.2460.

Sun, Qinghe, **Li Chen**, Mabel C Chou, and Qiang Meng. "Mitigating the financial risk behind emission cap compliance: A case in maritime transportation". *Production and Operations Management* 32, no. 1 (2023): 283–300. DOI: 10.1111/poms.13837.

Sun, Qinghe, **Li Chen**, and Qiang Meng. "Evaluating port efficiency dynamics: A risk-based approach". *Transportation Research Part B: Methodological* 166 (2022): 333–347. DOI: 10.1016/j.trb.2022.10.002.

Teaching

BCom Redesign Developer for *QBUS2310: Decision Analytics* at USYD	S1 2026
Coordinator for *QBUS2310: Management Science* at USYD	S1 2026
Coordinator for *QBUS2310: Management Science* at USYD	S2 2025
Coordinator for *QBUS2310: Management Science* at USYD	S1 2025
Coordinator for *QBUS2310: Management Science* at USYD	S2 2024
Tutor for *Optimization in Data Science & Machine Learning* at NUS	Summer 2022
Tutor for *MA3252: Linear and Network Optimization* at NUS	Spring 2019
TA for *DBA3701: Introduction to Optimization* at NUS	Fall 2018; 2022
TA for *BDC6304: Robust Modelling and Optimization* at NUS	Spring 2022
TA for *MA5268: Theory and Algorithm for Nonlinear Optimization* at NUS	Fall 2019

Recognitions

CSAMSE Early Career Fellow	2026
Finalist in The First INFORMS TSL Data-driven Research Challenge	2025
Third Place in Best Paper, Institute of Supply Chain and Operations Management	2024
Runner-Up in INFORMS Computing Society Harvey Greenberg Research Award	2023

Research Grants

Emerging Scholar Research Fellowship, "Managing inventory and pricing with contextual robust optimization", University of Sydney Business School, AUD 30,000	01/2025 – Present

Co-Investigator, General Research Fund,"Robust Flexibility Design for Operational Efficiency and Resilience", Grant No. 15507724, Hong Kong Research Grants Council, HKD 642,944 — 01/2025 – Present

Conference/Workshop Talks

INFORMS Annual Meeting at San Francisco, USA	2026
CSAMSE Annual Conference at Shenyang, China	2026
POMS-HK International Conference at The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen	2026
WOMBAT Optimisation Workshop at The University of Queensland, Brisbane	2025
UNSW Optimisation Day at University of New South Wales, Sydney	2025
INFORMS Annual Meeting at Atlanta, USA	2025
International Conference on Stochastic Programming at École des Ponts ParisTech	2025
Workshop on Robust Optimization at The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen	2025
POMS-HK International Conference at The Chinese University of Hong Kong	2025
Joint Meeting of the NZMS, AustMS and AMS at University of Auckland	2024
International Symposium on Mathematical Programming at Montréal, Canada	2024
POMS-HK International Conference at The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology	2024
WOMBAT Optimization Workshop at The University of Sydney	2023
INFORMS Annual Meeting at Phoenix, USA	2023
POMS-China International Conference at Hangzhou, China	2023
SIAM Conference on Optimization at Seattle, USA	2023
POMS-HK International Conference at The Hong Kong Polytechnic University	2023
INFORMS Annual Meeting at Indianapolis, USA	2022
INFORMS Annual Meeting, Online	2021
CSAMSE Annual Conference, Online	2021
MSOM Conference, Online	2021
POMS Annual Conference, Online	2021
INFORMS Annual Meeting at Seattle, USA	2019
CSAMSE Annual Conference at Chengdu, China	2019

Invited Seminars

School of Risk and Actuarial Studies, University of New South Wales, Australia	06/2026
School of Mathematics and Statistics, The University of Sydney, Australia	04/2026
Department of Management Science, Fudan University, China	01/2026
Department of Industrial Engineering, Tsinghua University, China	01/2026

Department of Management Science, University of Science and Technology of China, China	01/2026
Department of Management Science, University of Science and Technology of China, China	01/2025
Center for Operations Research and Intelligent Decision Making, Cardinal Operations	12/2024
Discipline of Business Analytics, The University of Sydney, Australia	01/2023
Department of Information Systems and Management Engineering, Southern University of Science and Technology, China	11/2022
School of Data Science, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen, China	11/2022
Department of Logistics and Maritime Studies, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Hong Kong	11/2022

Professional Service

Ad-hoc Journal Referee for

- *Computers and Operations Research*
- *Decision Sciences*
- *European Journal of Operational Research*
- *IISE Transactions*
- *INFORMS Journal on Computing*
- *Journal of Global Optimization*
- *Management Science*
- *Manufacturing & Service Operations Management*
- *Mathematical Programming Computation*
- *Omega*
- *Operations Research*
- *Optimization and Engineering*
- *Production and Operations Management*
- *Transportation Research Part B: Methodological*

Judge for

- *INFORMS Service Science Best Student Paper Competition* 2026
- *POMS-HK Best Student Paper Competition* 2026
- *Durham Early Career Scholars Professional Development Workshop* 2025
- *POMS-HK Best Student Paper Competition* 2025

Organising Committee for

- *WOMBAT Optimisation Workshop* 2024
- *Analytics for X Conference* 2022

Session Chair for

- *INFORMS Annual Meeting* 2026
- *CSAMSE Annual Conference* 2026
- *INFORMS International Conference* 2025

– *INFORMS Annual Meeting* 2023
– *INFORMS Annual Meeting* 2022
– *Analytics for X Conference* 2022
– *Analytics for X Conference* 2021